THE HR&OB SOCIETY, FMS DELHI

FANTASTIC CVs AND HOW TO BUILD THEM

A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO BRAGGING RESPONSIBLY

CV Points Framework

Your CV is the first thing a panel reads, and many interview questions come straight from it. Every point can turn into a question, so each one has to be specific, quantified and easy to defend.

Category A: Writing Each CV Point

Numbers in brackets are character counts, including spaces and punctuation.

1. Start with a Strong Action Verb

The Rule: ***Begin every point with a specific power verb (Led, Built, Negotiated etc)***

Do (POR): "Led a **35-member** core team of the annual B-school fest; drew **4,200+** footfall across **18** events in three days" (106)
Don't: "Was responsible for the organising team of the annual B-school fest that had 4,200+ footfall in 18 events" (105)

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Passive openers like "Was responsible for" that do not show what you did.

2. Quantify with a Baseline

The Rule: ***Keep the key number in the first half and write the change as "from X to Y" or "X vs Y target". Ask "so what?" after every point.***

Do (Industry): "Grew B2B order value from **₹5 Cr to ₹5.9 Cr** in **6 months** by redesigning distributor incentives for **120+** dealers" (109)
Don't: "Redesigned distributor incentive scheme for 120+ dealers across North India, which grew B2B order value by 18% in 6 months" (122, non-compliant)

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Keeping the result for the end of the line; listing duties with no amount or baseline.

3. Follow Action, Method, Result

The Framework: ***Action → Method → Result***

Do (Project): "Mapped **60** EV-charging sites in Delhi using GIS demand data; proposed **12** new sites to cut user travel by **30%**" (107)
Don't: "Proposed 12 locations to cut travel by 30% after a study; EV-charging sites in Delhi were mapped using GIS demand data" (118, non-compliant)

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Mixing up the order; writing in passive voice.

4. Bold Only What Matters

The Rule: ***Bold only 2-3 things per point: numbers, outcomes or ranks. Do not bold the verb.***

Do (Project): "Built churn prediction model for D2C brand with **0.86 AUC**; flagged **2,300** at-risk users for retention offers" (106)
Don't: "**Built churn prediction model** for a **D2C brand** with **0.86 AUC**; flagged **2,300** at-risk users for offers"

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Bolding full phrases, company names or the verb. Too much bold, and nothing stands out.

5. Stay within the Character Limit

The Rule: ***The superset character limits are: Industry Experience 105-120 characters, all other sections 98-107.*** No trailing spaces and no filler words like "very", "successfully" or "various".

Do (Industry): "Negotiated annual rate contracts with **14 vendors**, saving **₹1.2 Cr** in logistics spend; adopted across **3** plants" (108)
Don't: "Successfully negotiated annual rate contracts with 14 different logistics vendors, resulting in total savings of ₹1.2 Cr in spend" (129, non-compliant)

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Padding with filler to reach the limit; cutting scope and results to fit.

6. Keep Every Claim Defensible

The Rule: ***Know the baseline of each number, how it was measured and what your share was.*** *Misrepresentation is frowned upon.*

Do (Industry): "Reduced invoice processing errors by **22%** in a **4-member** team by building a validation checklist for **9** clients" (108)
Don't: "Single-handedly transformed the entire finance function, delivering 300% efficiency gains and ₹50 Cr savings to the company" (123, non-compliant)

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Claims that are not believable for one person and cannot be defended in the interview.

7. Do Not Repeat Verbs or Content

The Rule: ***No verb should be used twice in a section, and each point (preferably quantified), should add something new.***

Do (ECA): "Spearheaded campus recycling drive of **25 volunteers**; kept **1.8 tonnes** of waste out of landfill in **4 months**" (105)
Don't: "Managed a campus recycling drive..." followed by "Managed weekly peer-mentoring circles..."

Key Pointer - What to Avoid: Repeating one verb across points in the same section.

Category B: Section-wise Notes

1. What Each Section Needs

Important points for your structure:

1. **Industry Experience:** Start with business outcomes (revenue, cost, time, errors, clients). Put the strongest points first.
2. **Summer Internship:** The most important entry for finals. Give the outcome, whether your recommendation was implemented.
3. **Positions of Responsibility:** Mention the role and the club or committee. Quantify team size, budget or reach.
4. **Projects:** Mention the problem, method and outcome. Name the company or NGO, or the journal for research papers.
5. **CCAs:** Case competitions, quizzes, Olympiads, academic awards. Always mention rank, number of participants and level.
6. **ECAs:** Sports, cultural and social work. Mention level, result and how long you have been involved.
7. **Interests:** Pick genuine, slightly different interests you can talk about in depth, and keep up with recent news in each.

Category C: Updating Your CV for Final Placements

Why this matters: Panels in finals focus on what you have done during the MBA, especially the internship.

Important points for your structure:

1. **Spikes Ribbon:** Add your case competitions, internships, live projects, PPO/PPI (if any) and your best first-year achievement.
2. **Order of spikes:** **The first, third and fifth spikes catch the eyes the most. Ensure that they are the best spikes of your career so far. Things like case comps should find space here.**
3. **First-Year Achievements:** Add live projects, competitions, academic ranks and club or committee roles. Remove weaker pre-MBA points to make space.
4. **Tense:** Past tense for completed roles and projects. Present tense only for positions you currently hold.
5. **Confidential Data:** If internship numbers are under NDA, use percentages instead of absolute values.
6. **Explain Every Point:** Prepare a 1-minute explanation for each point: baseline, what you did, your role and the result.

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